Paper selection criteria

GEOTEC Journal Club

GEOTEC research group

2026-11-05

The facilitator picks **one paper of at most 15 pages**, guided by the two core criteria below, and announces it to all GEOTEC members **at least one week before the session**.

Core criteria

Every selected paper should meet **both** criteria:

Table 1: Core selection criteria

Criterion	What to look for
Relevance to the group	A clear link to GIScience; topic, method or data of interest to several GEOTEC members, not only the facilitator
Methodological interest	A method, design or validation approach worth dissecting, even outside members' own topics

Why these criteria?

Because the club trains critical reading rather than keeping up with a topic, a paper with rich methods or instructive writing is a better pick than one that is merely new or close to your own thesis.

Practical requirements

- ☐ Maximum 15 pages (excluding references and appendices)
- ☐ Accessible to all members: open access, or a PDF shared with everyone
- ☐ Readable by non-specialists in the group with reasonable effort
- ☐ Not already discussed in a previous session (check the archive)

Occasional picks

- Classic or landmark papers that everyone should know
- Recent preprints
- Controversial papers, which often teach the most about critical reading and debate

Announcement

At least one week before the session, the facilitator sends the following to all members (Geoinfo mailing list):

1. Full reference and DOI or link to the PDF
2. One or two sentences on why this paper was chosen
3. A reminder to bring one question or critique, using the shared guiding questions, to the session

> **i** Announcement email template
>
> **Subject:** GEOTEC Journal Club – *session date* – *Paper title*
>
> Dear all,
>
> For our next Journal Club session (*date, time, room*), we will discuss:
>
> *Author(s) (Year). Title. Journal. DOI/link*
>
> **Why this paper:** *one or two sentences.*
>
> Please read it before the session and bring one question or critique, using the shared guiding questions.
>
> *Facilitator name*